

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Copy Protected?

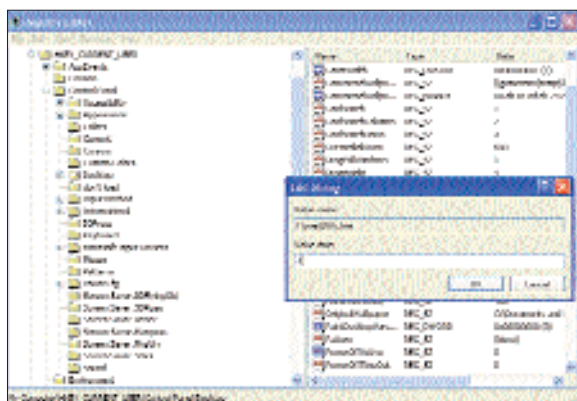
Q My PC's configuration is a Pentium 4 1.9 GHz, Intel 845G motherboard, 128 MB of RAM, Intel 82845G graphics chipset with 32 MB video memory. I have a problem when copying CDs to my hard disk. Whenever I try to copy, I get an error message that reads: "Data Error (Cyclic Redundancy Check)" and when I click 'OK', the error procedure cancels, and I cannot copy the data thereafter. How do I solve this problem? I have tried reinstalling the OS, but the error persists. I use Windows XP Home Edition. The error appears in all versions of Windows.

Gurmail Chand
Delhi

A The error you are experiencing is known as the CRC or 'Cyclic Redundancy Check' fail error. This error occurs when the data being copied appears to have lost its integrity or is corrupt. In your case, there may be two possible reasons for the error to occur: either your CD media is damaged or your CD drive has developed a fault. You may check if it is the first by trying to copy files to the hard disk on another computer. Or, get the CD drive serviced at an authorised service centre.

Mute Computer

Q I have a Pentium III 700 MHz system with an Intel 815 motherboard, 128 MB of RAM and a 20 GB hard drive with three partitions running Windows XP Professional. My problem is that I don't have my sound card drivers for XP. I searched the Intel Web site but found nothing. I have an AC 97 sound ALC100



Edit the PowerOffActive key in the registry

integrated sound card. Windows XP has installed its default drivers for my card, but the sound is very low even at full volume. My speakers are fine. Please tell me where can I get the drivers, and if possible, please include the drivers on the CD with the next issue!

Bijesh K
Thane

A The latest version of the driver for the ALC100 sound card is 3.71. You can download this driver from the RealTek Web site at <http://snipurl.com/86p8>. The size of these drivers is 11,453 KB. After installing, you will be able to access the extended features of your sound card as well. Please install the latest version of DirectX for smooth functioning of this sound card along with the drivers.

Write Error, Wrong Error?

Q When I write CDs on my PC, after 90 per cent writing is completed, a write error occurs and the CD becomes unusable. Although not consistent, this is a frequent occurrence. This problem occurs once in three to four write attempts. In the process column it shows 'Lead in' and 'Lead out', and in the action column, 'Failed' when the error occurs. The problem occurs in Windows 98 and XP Professional. My PC configuration is: ASUS CD writer, AMD Athlon processor, 512 MB of RAM, 80 GB hard disk, and the software used was Nero 5 and Nero 6 OEM version. I had also tried reinstalling the CD-Writing software.

Mahendra Gajbhiye
Indore

A Your problem could be caused by a variety of reasons. The most probable reason is that the brand of media you use might have a compatibility issue with your writer. You could try using another brand and confirm this. Another reason is that your CD-Writer's lens might have become dirty. This may be cleaned using a CD cleaner disc. If the problem is not solved, you might try upgrading the firmware for your CD-Writer. You may find the latest firmware for your CD-Writer from the ASUS Web site: www.asus.com/support/support.aspx.

If your drive is very old, the laser calibration could also have developed a fault. This is a result of the aging process of the CD writer and cannot be rectified.

Anti-virus In Hiding?

Q I own a Celeron 2 GHz Intel motherboard and 256 MB of RAM running Windows XP SP2. Recently, I installed Avast 4.6 Home edition. But the Windows security centre doesn't detect my anti-virus and it alerts me to install an anti-virus. Why does this happen? How can I overcome this?

T A Ravishankar
Palghat, Kerala

A Avast 4.6 Home Edition and other anti-virus software are not recognised by the Windows Security Centre. Hence, many anti-virus manufacturers have released newer versions of their